

Letter of Recommendation

For Mr. Lukáš Galeta for a Research Software Engineer – Finance position

Dear Sir or Madam,

Please accept this letter of recommendation on behalf of Mr. Lukáš Galeta. I met Lukáš in 2022, as he was attending my course, Artificial Intelligence in Finance, at the Masaryk University Brno (Czech Republic). I recall his first question during the lecture that caught me off-guard, as Lukáš was wondering why a certain test statistic (Hampel's filter) follows a certain probability distribution (χ^2). That was quite a detail he was interested in. It shows me that he was not there just to sit through the lecture, but he was there to learn. As I have published several articles in econophysics, during our course we have also covered topics in networks and complexity that use methods from physics to solve problems in finance. And yes, Lukáš got an A, used Python to code (the course was primarily in R) and won the forecasting challenge (Finance Challenge 1.0) on 22nd April.

Given this experience, I was quite happy that he selected me to be his thesis supervisor. It gave me the opportunity to get to know him a bit better. Lukáš proposed quite a challenging topic of using reinforced learning for trading purposes. That shows me that Lukáš is motivated, driven and not afraid to learn new skills. Given the challenging topic, I was initially worried, but it turned out great. Lukáš was working independently to an extent, that I had doubts whether I am a good supervisor. He solved all the issues of back-testing we had, and I liked the thesis a lot. Among the 120+ thesis that I supervised, Lukáš's work is in the top 3, and given my quantitative interests, I attract smart students that he is compared against.

Lukáš is goal oriented, and I see him as someone who makes sure that a job gets done. I do not see him as an extrovert, but he expresses his opinion. I think that is important, because where there is no fear of debate, the door to cooperation is open. On a personal level, I see him as a quant, not just by trade, but also by heart.

If you need any further information, do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely,
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